

colour with the values for Red, Green and Blue as 16 each instead of 0. Your text will get back its black shadow, and the background still looks black!



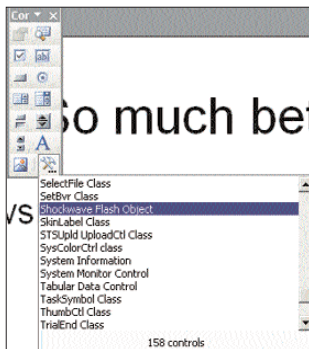
Flashy Flashy

You can include a Macromedia Flash movie in your presentation. Right-click on the PowerPoint toolbar and select Control Toolbox. At the bottom-right corner of the toolbox, click on the More Controls button and scroll down to select 'Shockwave Flash Object' to insert your Flash movie.



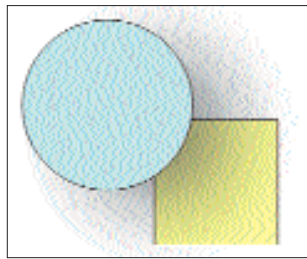
Soft Shadows

Instead of the coarse, often un-pretty shadow effects that PowerPoint



Adding Flash animations

offers, you can use a relatively simple technique to get good-looking shadows. Make a copy of the object you want to shadow, right-click on it and choose 'Format'. Under Fill > Colour, choose 'Fill Effects'



The correct usage of shadows

and select the Gradient tab. In Shading styles, choose 'From Center', and tweak the gradient colours as you see fit. After you're done, resize the duplicate object to around 150% of the original size, and place it behind the original object.



Undercover Buttons

If you want to set up a presentation that you can control by clicking action buttons, but want several of these buttons on each slide without cluttering up your slide too much, you need *Invisible* action buttons.

Draw the buttons—rectangles or any other shape you like—on the slide where you want them to appear, then assign them action settings by going to **Slide Show > Action Settings** and setting the options you want for each.

Test the buttons—start the slideshow and click each shape to make sure it's doing what it's supposed to.

To make them invisible, select the shapes and assign them a fill of No Fill and an outline of No Line through



Command Line Switches

Command Line switches for the PowerPoint Viewer (PowerPoint 2003)

Starting PowerPoint from Start > Run can offer you a good number of features:

What to enter: "<path>pptview.exe" [switches]

"<path>filename.ppt">

Where <path> is the fully qualified path to the PowerPoint executable and the presentation file (which might also be a PPS file) respectively. Quotes are really required only if there are spaces in the folder names, but it makes sense to use them all the time anyway.

Switch	Function
/A or /a	Automatic advance
/R=n-m or /r=n-m	Slide range (where n<=m)
/L or /l	Loop continuously
/P or /p	Print the file
/L	Read a playlist of files contained within a text file. Example: \pptview.exe /L "Playlist.txt"
/S	The playlist file itself is simply a list of
/D	presentation filenames (preceded by path as needed) and you can't use any additional command line switches for them
	Start without the splash screen
	Prompt the Open dialog box to appear when slide show ends
	Open presentation at a specified slide number "#".
/N#	For Example: /pptview.exe /n5 "presentation.ppt" would open at slide 5

the Format Object dialog.

Now try running your screen show again. You'll notice that even though the shapes are invisible, they still do what you've assigned them.

If you want these buttons on each slide, use the Slide Master—go to **View > Master > Slide Master** and create your action buttons on the Master slide. Anything you place on the Master slide appears on all slides in the presentation unless you specifically disable master items on a particular slide.

In your subsequent slides, you'll want to make sure that you don't completely cover up any action buttons you've placed on the Master slide.

Or, you could just put two of these invisible action buttons on each slide. Each one fills half the slide, so all you need to do is click the right side of the slide to advance to the next slide (if that is indeed what you want to do) in the presentation and the left side of the slide to go back to the previous slide.



Your Slideshow As A Whiteboard

Instead of using a separate

whiteboard to write down stuff on, you can simply turn on a whiteboard in your slideshow itself and use the pointer to write down what you want.

First, right-click on your slide and go to **Pointer Options** to select what writing instrument your pointer is going to simulate. Then, press [W] to white out the screen, and you can now use it as you please.



Using a slide as a whiteboard



Photo Albums In PowerPoint

Want to make a slide show out of your photo collection? It's quite simple: go to **Insert > Picture > New Photo Album**. And in the Photo Album dialog box, to add a picture from a file or disk, do the following: under 'Insert picture from', select File/Disk. Locate the folder or

Keyboard Shortcuts for Slideshows

(Number x) + [Enter]	Go to slide number x
[B]	Toggle between a black screen and the presentation
[W]	Toggle between a white screen and the presentation
[S]	Stop or restart an automatic slideshow
[Esc]	End a slideshow
[E]	Erase screen annotations
[H]	Go to the next hidden slide
[T]	Set new timings during rehearsal
[O]	Use default timings during rehearsal
[M]	Use mouse-clicks to advance during rehearsal
[Ctrl] + [H]	Hide the mouse pointer and button
[Ctrl] + [U]	Hide the mouse pointer and button after 15 seconds
[Ctrl] + [P]	Display the mouse pointer as a pen
[Ctrl] + [A]	Display the mouse pointer as an arrow
[Tab]	Go to the first or next hyperlink on the slide
[Shift] + [Tab]	Go to the last or previous hyperlink on the slide
[Enter] with hyperlink selected	Follow the Hyperlink (like [Ctrl]-clicking a hyperlink)